

WHAT IS A PLANT?

The leaves are used for making food.



Look, no hands

Some plants do not need soil—they prefer to perch in trees. A stag's horn fern gets a good grip by wrapping its large fronds around a branch.

Trees have a main stem and many branches.

An apple tree and a cactus do not look much like each other. But they have more in common than you might think. They are both plants. Like all other plants they make their own food, and during the course of their lifetime, they can produce many new plants. To do these things they use their roots, stems, leaves, and flowers. You will find that no matter how different one plant may look from another, each one is using these parts in much the same way, in order to live and grow.

Apples and other fruit contain seeds.

Hitching a lift

Some plants use other plants for support. This passion flower can climb very high by winding itself around the trunks and branches of trees.

The flowers make seeds for new plants.

The flexible stems can bend and twine.

Fresh fruit

Apple trees are not best known for their flowers.

But if they did not have flowers first, we would not have apples to eat.

